NEOLITHIC & CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES

FOOD PRODUCTION: A REGIONAL → DOMESTICATION EVIDENCE AND CAUSAL → TECHNOLOGY-SETTLEMENT-SOCIAL CONSEQUENCE CHAIN → INDIAN NEOLITHIC REGIONAL MAP → ASH MOUNDS: FORMATION-FUNCTION DEBATE → CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES: REGION-SITE-MARKER MATRIX

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g13 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

FOOD PRODUCTION: A REGIONAL MOSAIC

FOOD PRODUCTION · A REGIONAL MOSAIC · MIXED FARMING · SURPLUS/STORAGE WILD USE SELECTIVE TENDING HERITABLE CHANGE CROPS+HERDS DELAYED · NO UNIVERSAL PACKAGE · POLISHED STONE, POTTERY, HERDING AND CROPS APPEAR IN VARIED · NEOLITHIC CHANGES LIFEWAYS; CHALCOLITHIC ADDS COPPER WITHIN STONE-USING ECONOMIES.

FORAGING → MANAGEMENT → DOMESTICATION → MIXED FARMING → SURPLUS/STORAGE wild use selective tending heritable → No universal package: polished stone, pottery, herding and crops appear in varied order. → Neolithic changes lifeways; Chalcolithic adds copper within stone-using economies.

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- FORAGING → MANAGEMENT → DOMESTICATION → MIXED FARMING → SURPLUS/STORAGE wild use selective tending heritable change crops+herds delayed consumption
- No universal package: polished stone, pottery, herding and crops appear in varied order.

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- Neolithic changes lifeways; Chalcolithic adds copper within stone-using economies.
- FORAGING → MANAGEMENT → DOMESTICATION → MIXED FARMING → SURPLUS/STORAGE wild use selective tending heritable change crops+herds delayed consumption

IMPACT / LIMIT

- No universal package: polished stone, pottery, herding and crops appear in varied order.
- Neolithic changes lifeways; Chalcolithic adds copper within stone-using economies.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Neolithic changes lifeways; Chalcolithic adds copper within stone-using economies.

01

STAGE 01

DOMESTICATION EVIDENCE AND CAUSAL DEBATE

DOMESTICATION EVIDENCE AND CAUSAL DEBATE · SEED-SIZE/RACHIS CHANGE + WEED ECOLOGY + STORAGE + GRINDING · MORPHOLOGY + AGE/SEX KILL PROFILE + CORRALS/DUNG + HERD · RISK BUFFERING · SOCIAL COMPETITION · NICHE CONSTRUCTION · DOMESTICATION NEEDS CONVERGING BIOLOGICAL AND CONTEXTUAL EVIDENCE · RICE PRESENCE ALONE DOES NOT PROVE CULTIVATION; SECURE DATE

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- PLANTS: seed-size/rachis change + weed ecology + storage + grinding tools
- ANIMALS: morphology + age/sex kill profile + corrals/dung + herd demography
- CAUSES: climate

METHOD / DEBATE

- risk buffering
- social competition
- niche construction

HISTORICAL RESULT

- VERDICT: domestication needs converging biological and contextual evidence.
- Rice presence alone does not prove cultivation; secure date and morphology matter.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: domestication needs converging biological and contextual evidence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Rice presence alone does not prove cultivation; secure date and morphology matter.

02

STAGE 02

TECHNOLOGY-SETTLEMENT-SOCIAL CONSEQUENCE CHAIN

TECHNOLOGY-SETTLEMENT-SOCIAL CONSEQUENCE CHAIN · POLISHED STONE + MICROLITHS + BONE TOOLS + POTTERY · LONGER RESIDENCE · ACCUMULATED PROPERTY CRAFT/EXCHANGE GROWTH DISEASE, LABOUR LOAD AND DIETARY

polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses → → storage → longer residence → accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and → dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not inevitable.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses →
- storage → longer residence → accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not inevitable.
- polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses →

DEBATE / LEGACY

- storage → longer residence → accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and
- dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not inevitable.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses → storage → longer residence → accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not inevitable.

03

STAGE 03

INDIAN NEOLITHIC REGIONAL MAP

INDIAN NEOLITHIC REGIONAL MAP · LONG FARMING/HERDING SEQUENCE BEFORE HARAPPAN URBANISM · BURZAHOM, GUFKRAL · PIT DWELLINGS, BONE TOOLS, AGRO-PASTORALISM · VINDHYA/MIDDLE GANGA · KOLDIHWA, MAHAGARA, LAHURADEWA · RICE/DATE CAUTIONS · SHOULDERED CELTS AND REGIONAL LINKS; CHRONOLOGY REMAINS UNEVEN

NORTH-WEST: Mehrgarh → long farming/herding sequence before Harappan urbanism

KASHMIR: Burzahom, Gufkral → pit dwellings, bone tools, agro-pastoralism → VINDHYA/MIDDLE GANGA: Koldihwa, Mahagara, Lahuradewa → rice/date cautions → NORTH-EAST: shouldered celts and regional links; chronology remains uneven

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- NORTH-WEST: Mehrgarh → long farming/herding sequence before Harappan urbanism
- KASHMIR: Burzahom, Gufkral → pit dwellings, bone tools, agro-pastoralism

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- VINDHYA/MIDDLE GANGA: Koldihwa, Mahagara, Lahuradewa → rice/date cautions
- NORTH-EAST: shouldered celts and regional links; chronology remains uneven

DEBATE / LEGACY

- SOUTH: Utnur, Pikihal, Tekkalakota, Hallur → cattle, millets, ash mounds
- RULE: attach each site to region + marker + chronological caution.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: attach each site to region + marker + chronological caution.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: attach each site to region + marker + chronological caution.

04

STAGE 04

ASH MOUNDS: FORMATION-FUNCTION DEBATE

ASH MOUNDS · FORMATION-FUNCTION DEBATE · BURNT CATTLE DUNG + ENCLOSURE/SETTLEMENT CONTEXT · SOUTH INDIAN ASH MOUND PERIODIC PEN BURNING COMMUNAL FEASTING · REPEATED FIRING AND CATTLE CENTRALITY ARE STRONG; ONE EXCLUSIVE · USE UTNUR AND RELATED SITES AS A PASTORAL-LANDSCAPE PROBLEM

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- BURNT CATTLE DUNG + ENCLOSURE/SETTLEMENT CONTEXT → SOUTH INDIAN ASH MOUND periodic pen burning communal feasting sanitation/fuel practice
- Repeated firing and cattle centrality are strong; one exclusive ritual meaning is not.

METHOD / DEBATE

- Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.
- BURNT CATTLE DUNG + ENCLOSURE/SETTLEMENT CONTEXT → SOUTH INDIAN ASH MOUND periodic pen burning communal feasting sanitation/fuel practice

HISTORICAL RESULT

- Repeated firing and cattle centrality are strong; one exclusive ritual meaning is not.
- Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.

05

STAGE 05

CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES: REGION-SITE-MARKER MATRIX

CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES · REGION-SITE-MARKER MATRIX · CULTURE/ZONE CORE SITES HIGH-YIELD MARKERS · GANESHWAR-JODHPURA GANESHWAR/JODHPURA COPPER CRAFT; HARAPPAN CONTACT · AHAR-BANAS AHAR, BALATHAL, GILUND BLACK-RED WARE; COPPER; FARMING · KAYATHA KAYATHA EARLY MALWA SEQUENCE; RICH DEPOSITS · MALWA NAVDATOLI; ERAN, NAGDA PAINTED WARE; LARGE VILLAGES; SPREAD · JORWE INAMGAON, NEVASA DECCAN HIERARCHY; LATE JORWE

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
CULTURE/ZONE CORE SITES HIGH-YIELD MARKERS	Kayatha Kayatha early Malwa sequence; rich deposits	OCP/Copper Hoards upper Ganga sites association varies; no ethnic label
Ganeshwar-Jodhpura Ganeshwar/Jodhpura copper craft; Harappan contact	Malwa Navdatoli, Eran, Nagda painted ware; large villages; spread	
Ahar-Banas Ahar, Balathal, Gilund black-red ware; copper; farming	Jorwe Inamgaon, Nevasa Deccan hierarchy; Late Jorwe	

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- CULTURE/ZONE CORE SITES HIGH-YIELD MARKERS
- Ganeshwar-Jodhpura Ganeshwar/Jodhpura copper craft; Harappan contact
- Ahar-Banas Ahar, Balathal, Gilund black-red ware; copper; farming

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Kayatha Kayatha early Malwa sequence; rich deposits
- Malwa Navdatoli, Eran, Nagda painted ware; large villages; spread
- Jorwe Inamgaon, Nevasa Deccan hierarchy; Late Jorwe

DEBATE / LEGACY

- OCP/Copper Hoards upper Ganga sites association varies; no ethnic label

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OCP/Copper Hoards upper Ganga sites association varies; no ethnic label.

06

STAGE 06

CHALCOLITHIC RURAL POLITICAL ECONOMY

CHALCOLITHIC RURAL POLITICAL ECONOMY · VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS · CROP/HERD PRODUCTION · CRAFT WORK · EXCHANGE UNEQUAL HOUSES RISK AND SURPLUS COPPER/POTTERY REGIONAL NETWORKS · SETTLEMENT HIERARCHY AND DIFFERENTIAL BURIALS MAY INDICATE INEQUALITY. · MOST SYSTEMS WERE REGIONAL AND RURAL, NOT FAILED HARAPPAN

VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS → crop/herd production → storage → craft work → exchange unequal houses risk → Settlement hierarchy and differential burials may indicate inequality. → Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS → crop/herd production → storage → craft work → exchange unequal houses risk and surplus copper/pottery regional networks
- Settlement hierarchy and differential burials may indicate inequality.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.
- VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS → crop/herd production → storage → craft work → exchange unequal houses risk and surplus copper/pottery regional networks

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Settlement hierarchy and differential burials may indicate inequality.
- Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

07

STAGE 07

DECLINE, TRANSFORMATION AND CULTURAL LABELS

DECLINE, TRANSFORMATION AND CULTURAL LABELS · LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE · ARIDITY + PRODUCTION STRESS + SETTLEMENT REORGANISATION SOME ABANDONMENT · CAUTION 1 · ARCHAEOLOGICAL CULTURE · MATERIAL PATTERN, NOT A NAMED PEOPLE. · CAUTION 2 · COPPER USE DOES NOT DISPLACE STONE OR PROVE URBANISATION.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE: aridity + production stress + settlement reorganisation some
- abandonment + smaller settlements + mobile strategies + local continuity

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- CAUTION 1: archaeological culture = material pattern, not a named people.
- CAUTION 2: copper use does not displace stone or prove urbanisation.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- CAUTION 3: Neolithic, Chalcolithic and Harappan worlds overlap and interact.
- LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE: aridity + production stress + settlement reorganisation some

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION 3: Neolithic, Chalcolithic and Harappan worlds overlap and interact.

08

STAGE 08

NEOLITHIC-CHALCOLITHIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

NEOLITHIC-CHALCOLITHIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE · 10 MARKS · DEFINE PHASE · TWO REGIONAL SITES · EVIDENCE CAUTION · 15 MARKS · TRANSITION CAUSES · DOMESTICATION PROOF

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- 10 MARKS: define phase → process → two regional sites → evidence caution
- 15 MARKS: transition causes → domestication proof → technology/settlement → comparison

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 20 MARKS: mosaic chronology → regional map → Chalcolithic matrix → economy/society
- ash-mound debate → transformation → qualified synthesis

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Use triads: region + site + marker; never write an undifferentiated site catalogue.
- CLOSE: food production reorganised time, labour and settlement through diverse paths.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE: food production reorganised time, labour and settlement through diverse paths.

09

STAGE 09

EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL

EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL · EVIDENCE LADDER · FROM SOURCE BOOK · STANDARD KNOWLEDGE · CURRENT AFFAIRS. · 2. SOUTH INDIAN NEOLITHIC EVIDENCE INCLUDES CATTLE PASTORALISM, POLISHED · 3. CULTURE · SITE REGION SIGNATURE MARKER

SOURCE / MATERIAL	METHOD / DEBATE	HISTORICAL RESULT
EVIDENCE LADDER	2. South Indian Neolithic evidence includes cattle pastoralism, polished...	VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.
1. = from source book + inference / standard knowledge + current affairs.	3. Culture / site Region Signature marker	EVIDENCE LADDER

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- EVIDENCE LADDER
- 1. = from source book + inference / standard knowledge + current affairs.

METHOD / DEBATE

- 2. South Indian Neolithic evidence includes cattle pastoralism, polished...
- 3. Culture / site Region Signature marker

HISTORICAL RESULT

- VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.
- EVIDENCE LADDER

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

10

STAGE 10

EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES

EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES · CLOSE DISTINCTIONS · 1. EVIDENCE DISCIPLINE · CONTESTED CHRONOLOGY AND INTERPRETATION REMAIN · 2. CONTESTED ISSUES COMPETING INTERPRETATIONS ARE ATTRIBUTED, EVIDENCED · 3. INSCRIPTION AND COIN EVIDENCE · CONTEMPORARY NAMES, TITLES, CLAIMS AND · QUALIFICATION EARNS MARKS; FALSE CERTAINTY IS A HARD FAILURE.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
CLOSE DISTINCTIONS	2. Contested issues Competing interpretations are attributed, evidenced...	VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.
1. Evidence discipline: contested chronology and interpretation remain...	3. Inscription and coin evidence: contemporary names, titles, claims and...	CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- CLOSE DISTINCTIONS
- 1. Evidence discipline: contested chronology and interpretation remain...

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 2. Contested issues Competing interpretations are attributed, evidenced...
- 3. Inscription and coin evidence: contemporary names, titles, claims and...

DEBATE / LEGACY

- VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.
- CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.

11

STAGE 11

INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION · ANSWER SPINE · 1. BASIC COMPLETENESS5 · EVERY SUBSTANTIVE OWNER POINT IS RETAINED IN A · 2. OFFICIAL LOCAL PAPER · UPSC CIVIL SERVICES PRELIMINARY EXAMINATION · 3. VERIFIED QUESTION; INFERRED ANSWER/KEY - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED · CLAIM, NAMED EVIDENCE, ANALYSIS AND QUALIFICATION LEAD TO A

ANSWER SPINE → 1. Basic completeness: every substantive owner point is retained in a → 2. Official local paper: UPSC Civil Services Preliminary Examination → 3. Verified question; inferred answer/key - not officially verified 1 → VERDICT: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- ANSWER SPINE
- 1. Basic completeness: every substantive owner point is retained in a...

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 2. Official local paper: UPSC Civil Services Preliminary Examination...
- 3. Verified question; inferred answer/key - not officially verified 1

DEBATE / LEGACY

- VERDICT: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded...
- ANSWER SPINE

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · 1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA · 2. KEY CLASSIFICATION · 3. STUDY LINKS · 4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS) · 5. UPSC TRAPS · 6. CURRENT LINK · 7. MAINS ANGLES

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Mini-timeline
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data
- 3. Study links

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)
- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link
- 7. Mains angles

LEGACY / NUANCE

- Optional Advanced Case Clinics: Evidence Without Overreach — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- At Koldihwa, Mahagara, Pachoh and Indari, key issues are dates and whether rice remains are wild or domesticated.
- Upinder Singh also highlights Lahuradewa as evidence that the middle Ganga valley
- was an early rice-cultivation zone, preventing a single north-west-to-east diffusion model.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels